

Classification: Internal

AETHERIA INFRASTRUCTURE RESEARCH (AIR)

Information Security Policy

AIR-ISMS-POL-001 | Version 1.0 | May 2026

Document Control

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Approved By	Chief Executive Officer
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Related Documents	AIR-ISMS-POL-002 Access Control Policy AIR-ISMS-POL-003 Incident Response Policy AIR-ISMS-RSK-001 Risk Assessment Methodology AIR-ISMS-RSK-002 Risk Register AIR-ISMS-AST-001 Asset Inventory AIR-ISMS-SCO-001 ISMS Scope Statement
Applicable Standard	ISO/IEC 27001:2022 — Clauses 5.1, 5.2, 6.2, 7.3

Statement of Commitment

Aetheria Infrastructure Research handles sensitive government-affiliated research data, critical infrastructure analysis outputs, and proprietary AI technologies on behalf of public-sector partners, academic institutions, and infrastructure operators across Europe. The trust placed in us by these partners depends entirely on our ability to protect the information we hold.

This policy reflects our commitment to managing information security with the same rigour we apply to our research. It is not a compliance exercise. It is a statement of how we operate.

Every person at AIR — employees, contractors, and collaborators — is responsible for upholding the standards set out here. Protecting our information is a shared professional obligation.

Chief Executive Officer | Aetheria Infrastructure Research | May 2026

1. Purpose

This policy establishes AIR's commitment to protecting the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information assets across its operations. It defines the principles, obligations, and governance structure that underpin AIR's Information Security Management System (ISMS).

This policy applies to all information handled by AIR, regardless of format, location, or the system used to process it, and sets the standard against which all other information security documents and controls are aligned.

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2. Scope

This policy applies to all AIR personnel, including:

- Permanent employees across all departments and all office locations (Madrid, Brussels, Riga)
- Contractors, research collaborators, and temporary staff with access to AIR systems or information
- Third parties who access, process, or store AIR information under a contractual or partnership arrangement

It covers all information assets within the ISMS scope as defined in AIR-ISMS-SCO-001, including Azure cloud infrastructure, Microsoft 365, GitHub Enterprise, research data repositories, managed endpoints, and all systems used to conduct AIR's research and operational activities.

This policy does not apply to unmanaged personal devices or third-party systems outside AIR's operational control, as documented in the ISMS Scope Statement.

3. Information Security Objectives

AIR's information security objectives for the current ISMS cycle are:

Objective	Description	Primary Metric
Protect Restricted Research Data	Ensure government-affiliated research datasets and critical infrastructure analysis outputs are handled in accordance with contractual and regulatory obligations.	Zero unauthorised disclosures of Restricted data
Achieve Full MFA Coverage	Enforce multi-factor authentication for all user accounts with access to AIR systems, with no exceptions.	100% MFA coverage across Entra ID tenancy
Complete Risk Treatment Programme	Implement planned treatment actions for all High-rated risks by end of Q4 2026, reducing residual scores to Medium or below.	0 untreated High risks by 31 Dec 2026
Formalise Supplier Security	Ensure all suppliers handling Restricted or Confidential AIR data are subject to a documented security assessment and contractual security requirements.	100% of Tier 1 suppliers assessed by Q1 2027
Build Security Awareness	Ensure all employees and contractors complete mandatory information security awareness training within 30 days of onboarding and annually thereafter.	100% training completion rate

Objectives are reviewed annually as part of the ISMS management review. Progress is reported quarterly to Executive Leadership by the Head of Security & Compliance.

4. Security Principles

The following principles guide all information security decisions at AIR:

Confidentiality: Information is accessible only to those with a legitimate need and appropriate authorisation. Access is granted on the basis of role, not convenience.

Integrity: Information is accurate, complete, and protected from unauthorised modification. Research data and AI model outputs must remain trustworthy.

Availability: Systems and information are accessible to authorised users when needed. Service continuity is planned and tested, particularly for research-critical systems.

Least Privilege: Users and systems are granted only the minimum access required to perform their function. Privileged access is time-limited, documented, and reviewed regularly.

Risk Proportionality: Security controls are proportionate to the risk they address. Restricted information receives stronger controls than Internal information.

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Accountability: Every information asset has an owner. Every access decision has an accountable person. Security responsibilities are defined, communicated, and enforced.

Continuous Improvement: AIR's security posture is assessed regularly and improved systematically. Incidents, audit findings, and risk register changes drive updates to controls and policies.

5. Information Classification

All information assets must be classified according to AIR's Information Classification Standard (AIR-ISMS-CLS-001). Classification determines the handling, storage, transmission, and disposal requirements for information.

Level	Description	Examples
Restricted	Highest protection level. Disclosure or loss would cause severe harm to AIR, its partners, or the public.	Government-affiliated research data, AI model weights, incident evidence, security configurations
Confidential	Significant protection required. Disclosure would cause material harm to AIR or its partners.	Partner contracts, HR records, financial data, unpublished AI source code
Internal	Standard protection. For use within AIR only. Not for external distribution.	Working research documents, internal reports, project plans, meeting notes
Public	No restrictions on distribution. Approved for external release.	Peer-reviewed publications, press releases, approved conference presentations

Where classification is unclear, the asset owner must apply the higher classification until a formal determination is made. Downgrading a classification requires written approval from the Head of Security & Compliance.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

Information security is a shared responsibility. The following roles carry specific accountabilities under this policy:

Role	Responsibility
Executive Leadership	Sets the organisation's risk appetite. Approves this policy and reviews it annually. Ensures adequate resources are allocated to information security. Acts as the escalation point for Critical risks.
Head of Security & Compliance	Owns and maintains the ISMS. Develops and updates security policies and procedures. Manages the risk assessment cycle. Reports security performance to Executive Leadership. Coordinates incident response.
Department Heads and Asset Owners	Accountable for information assets within their area. Ensure their teams comply with this policy and related standards. Approve access requests. Escalate incidents and risks.
IT Operations	Implements and maintains technical security controls. Manages access provisioning and deprovisioning. Maintains system logs and monitoring. Supports incident response.
Head of Legal & Partnerships	Ensures contractual and regulatory security obligations are incorporated into partner and supplier agreements. Advises on GDPR and data protection compliance.
All Employees and Contractors	Comply with this policy and all related security policies. Complete mandatory security training. Report security incidents, suspected breaches, or control weaknesses promptly to the Head of Security & Compliance.

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7. Policy Framework

This policy sits at the top of AIR's information security policy hierarchy. It is supported by a set of topic-specific policies that provide detailed requirements for particular control areas:

Document	Document ID	Scope
Access Control Policy	AIR-ISMS-POL-002	User access management, privileged access, contractor access, access reviews
Incident Response Policy	AIR-ISMS-POL-003	Incident classification, reporting, investigation, and post-incident review
Acceptable Use Policy	AIR-ISMS-POL-004	Permitted use of AIR systems, devices, email, internet, and AI tools
Data Classification Standard	AIR-ISMS-CLS-001	Classification levels, handling requirements, labelling, and disposal
Supplier Security Policy	AIR-ISMS-POL-005	Supplier security assessments, contractual requirements, and ongoing reviews
Business Continuity Policy	AIR-ISMS-POL-006	Continuity planning, backup requirements, recovery objectives

In the event of a conflict between this policy and a topic-specific policy, this policy takes precedence. All topic-specific policies must be consistent with the principles established here.

8. Mandatory Requirements

The following requirements apply to all AIR personnel without exception:

Access control: Access to AIR systems and information must be authorised, role-appropriate, and reviewed at least annually. Shared accounts are prohibited.

Multi-factor authentication: MFA is mandatory for all accounts with access to AIR systems. There are no exceptions.

Incident reporting: All suspected or confirmed security incidents must be reported to the Head of Security & Compliance within four hours of discovery.

Security training: All personnel must complete mandatory security awareness training within 30 days of joining AIR and annually thereafter.

Data handling: Information must be handled in accordance with its classification level. Restricted data must not be processed using unsanctioned tools or services.

Device use: AIR business information must only be processed on AIR-managed devices or systems explicitly approved by IT Operations.

Offboarding: Access to all AIR systems must be revoked within 24 hours of a person's last working day, whether employee or contractor.

Supplier obligations: Third parties handling AIR Restricted or Confidential data must sign a data processing agreement and complete a security assessment before access is granted.

9. Non-Compliance

Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment or contract. Where non-compliance results in a data breach or legal violation, AIR reserves the right to pursue appropriate legal remedies. All allegations of non-compliance will be investigated fairly and proportionately.

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Non-compliance should be reported to the Head of Security & Compliance or, where the non-compliance involves that individual, directly to the Chief Executive Officer. AIR does not tolerate retaliation against anyone who reports a genuine security concern in good faith.

10. Review and Maintenance

This policy is reviewed annually by the Head of Security & Compliance and approved by the Chief Executive Officer. It will also be reviewed following:

- Any significant change to AIR's operating environment, technology, or organisational structure
- Any security incident that reveals a gap or ambiguity in this policy
- Changes to applicable law or regulation (including GDPR and sector-specific obligations)
- Findings from internal audits or external certification assessments

All employees and contractors will be notified of material changes to this policy. Acknowledgement of this policy is required during onboarding and upon each annual revision.

11. Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Document Owner	Head of Security & Compliance		May 20, 2026
Executive Approver	Chief Executive Officer		May 20, 2026